

# Laura Marshall

Design Systems Leader

Portfolio [lauramarshall.design](http://lauramarshall.design)

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## Experience

### Visual Design Lead

IBM · 2019–present

Design systems · Product design

Seven years at IBM spanning product design and design systems — shipping features across enterprise products while building, contributing to, and driving adoption of the Carbon Design System (IBM's design system) at scale.

### Career highlights include

- Leading a team of 10 designers to build the Carbon for IBM Products Figma kit from scratch — applying Carbon's token architecture, defining the roadmap, reviewing all contributions, and shipping 30+ components with **165% adoption growth** in five months.
- Researching design-to-development collaboration across **100+ developers in 12 countries** — identifying the cultural root cause, publishing guidance, and establishing practices that brought design and engineering into shared ownership earlier.
- Leading a team of designers to drive Carbon adoption across **8 acquired products in 9 months** — defining the governance model, influencing teams who hadn't chosen the system, and building the compliance framework used to report progress to senior leadership.
- Contributing many components and patterns to Carbon alongside my day job in product — including button guidance, full page errors (identified through an accessibility contrast gap in dark mode), tag overflow and grid influencers — identifying gaps through product work and driving them through the formal contribution process into system-level standards used across IBM.
- Using AI-assisted workflows to contribute visual design fixes directly into production code — merged into a live IBM product — the first designer in my organisation to bridge design and code this way.
- Designing an AI-driven radiology triage system — filed as a US patent in 2022 — applying machine learning to surface the most critical cases first, before AI tooling was a mainstream conversation in product.
- Building IBM's Product Gallery — making good design visible and reusable across IBM's global design community.
- Mentoring **10+ designers** across my career — on design systems, contribution processes, and visual design craft.

### Industry Lecturer

University of Reading · 2019–2025

For six years I led a compulsory second year app design module — covering user-centred design, design thinking, and helping students build design systems for their projects.

## Education

### First Class – BA Graphic Communication

University of Reading · 2019

Dissertation exploring Braille's relevance alongside emerging technological alternatives — later published as a piece of design research.

## Awards

### Technical Collaboration Achievement Programme

IBM · 2023, 2024

*Recognition for significant contributions to Carbon for IBM Products and the broader open source ecosystem.*

### Growth Award

IBM · 2022

*Recognised for exceptional leadership delivering the Carbon for IBM Products Figma kit — essential to IBM's move to Figma, saving every team from recreating assets from scratch.*

### Carbon Champion

IBM · 2022, 2024

*Recognised twice — for aligning Carbon components and guidance across product teams via the Design System Adoption Guild, and for creating the Product Gallery to foster consistency across IBM's design community.*

### RockIT Award

IBM · 2019

*Best Newcomer. Recognised for a can-do, ask-why mentality and high quality visual design across product and community work.*

## Patents

### Artificial Intelligence Prioritization of Abnormal Radiology Scans

United States Patent Office · 2022

A machine learning system that pre-reads scans, surfaces the most critical image, and prioritises urgent cases by severity — before the radiologist opens anything.

## Published research

### Braille in an evolving technological world

Visible Language Journal · 2020

Research into people's experiences of Braille as a reading method. Published in the oldest peer-reviewed design journal, with an acceptance rate below 20%.